

CostSmart

Monthly Budget Template

Take control of your finances with the 50/30/20 framework

How to Use This Template

1. Track all your income sources on Page 2
2. Categorize expenses using the 50/30/20 rule on Page 3
3. Set and monitor savings goals on Page 4
4. Plan your debt payoff strategy on Page 5
5. Complete the monthly review checklist on Page 6

The 50/30/20 Rule Explained

50% - NEEDS

Essential expenses you cannot avoid:

- Housing / Rent
- Utilities
- Groceries
- Transportation
- Insurance

30% - WANTS

Lifestyle choices that improve quality of life:

- Entertainment
- Dining Out
- Shopping
- Subscriptions
- Travel

20% - SAVINGS

Building wealth and reducing debt:

- Emergency Fund
- Investments/SIP
- Extra Debt Payments
- Retirement Fund

Quick Tips for Success

Print this template or fill it in digitally each month

Review your budget weekly to stay on track

Adjust categories to match your lifestyle - the 50/30/20 is a guideline

Use the Monthly Review Checklist (Page 6) to close out each month

Visit costsmart.app for interactive calculators and AI-powered insights

Budget Month: _____ Year: _____

Income Tracking Worksheet

Month: _____

Record all sources of income for the month. Compare expected vs actual to improve future budgets.

Income Source	Expected	Actual	Difference
Primary Salary/Wages	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Secondary Job	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Freelance / Contract Work	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Investment Income (Dividends)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Rental Income	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Side Hustle / Gig Work	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Government Benefits	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Child Support / Alimony	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Other Income 1	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Other Income 2	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
TOTAL INCOME	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

Income Notes:

Expense Categories (50/30/20 Rule)

NEEDS (50%)	Budget	Actual	Difference
Housing / Rent / Mortgage	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Utilities (Electric, Gas, Water)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Groceries & Household	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Transportation (Gas, Transit)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Insurance (Health, Auto, Home)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Minimum Debt Payments	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Phone / Internet	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Childcare / Education	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
SUBTOTAL	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

WANTS (30%)	Budget	Actual	Difference
Entertainment (Movies, Games)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Dining Out / Takeaway	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Shopping (Clothes, Electronics)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Subscriptions (Streaming, Gym)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Travel / Vacations	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Hobbies & Recreation	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Personal Care / Beauty	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
SUBTOTAL	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

SAVINGS & DEBT REPAYMENT (20%)	Budget	Actual	Difference
Emergency Fund	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Investments / SIP / Mutual Funds	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Extra Debt Payments	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Retirement (401k, IRA, NPS)	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Education Savings	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Other Savings Goals	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
SUBTOTAL	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

TOTAL EXPENSES	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
-----------------------	-----------------	-----------------	-----------------

Savings Goals Tracker

Define your financial goals and track progress monthly. Break big goals into manageable monthly contributions.

Goal Name	Target Amount	Current Saved	Monthly Amt	Target Date	Progress
Emergency Fund (6 months) _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___	_____%
Vacation / Travel Fund _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___	_____%
Down Payment / Home _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___	_____%
New Car / Vehicle _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___	_____%
Education / Course _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___	_____%

Goal Progress Bars (shade in your progress)



Pro Tip: Automate your savings!
Set up automatic transfers on payday so savings happen before spending.
Even small amounts add up - \$50/month becomes \$600/year plus interest.

Debt Payoff Planner

List all debts and plan your payoff strategy. Focus extra payments on the highest interest debt (Avalanche) or the smallest balance (Snowball) for psychological wins.

Creditor / Debt	Balance	Interest %	Min Payment	Extra Pmt	Payoff Date
Credit Card 1	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Credit Card 2	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Student Loan	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Car Loan	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Personal Loan	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Medical Debt	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Store Credit	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
Other Debt	\$ _____	_____%	\$ _____	\$ _____	___/___/___
TOTALS	\$ _____		\$ _____	\$ _____	

Payoff Strategy

My chosen method: ☐ Avalanche (highest interest first) ☐ Snowball (smallest balance first)

Total monthly debt budget: \$ _____

Extra amount available for debt: \$ _____

Debt-free target date: _____

Debt Payoff Milestones

First debt paid off: _____ Date achieved: ___/___/___

50% of total debt paid: _____ Date achieved: ___/___/___

Completely debt-free: _____ Date achieved: ___/___/___

Monthly Review Checklist

Complete this checklist at the end of each month to stay on track and improve your budgeting.

End-of-Month Review

- ☐ Recorded all income received this month
- ☐ Categorized and recorded all expenses
- ☐ Compared actual spending vs budget for each category
- ☐ Identified any overspending areas
- ☐ Updated savings goals progress
- ☐ Made all minimum debt payments on time
- ☐ Applied extra payments to target debt
- ☐ Reviewed and cancelled unused subscriptions
- ☐ Checked all bills for errors or unexpected charges
- ☐ Updated net worth calculation
- ☐ Set next month budget based on learnings
- ☐ Celebrated wins (no matter how small!)

Monthly Summary

Total Income: \$ _____

Total Expenses: \$ _____

Net Savings: \$ _____

Savings Rate: _____ %

Next Month Adjustments

What worked well this month:

What needs improvement:

Specific changes for next month: